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Tunis, Tunisia · open to relocation to Paris

Rihem Akkari

Threat intelligence · NLP · critical studies of technology

Cybersecurity engineer (ESPRIT, highest honours) who builds threat-intelligence and detection systems end to end, from data collection and NLP classification to SOC integration, and writes about the politics of the infrastructures she secures. Looking for research-engineer and doctoral roles in Paris.

EXPERIENCE

Threat Intelligence Engineer (final-year internship) · ANCS, National Cybersecurity Agency, Tunis — Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

DarkWatch: dark-web and OSINT threat-intelligence platform

- Designed and built a collection pipeline over 14 dark-web, leak-site and OSINT sources, with a FastAPI / PostgreSQL / React stack.
- Trained an NLP classifier (TF-IDF + logistic regression) sorting findings into 6 threat categories at 82.6% accuracy, chosen for interpretability.
- Surfaced 108 unique findings (6 critical, 35 high) from 127 collected; prepared SOC integration via a Security Onion webhook.
- Supervisor evaluation 19/20, highlighting autonomy, rigour and speed of learning.

SOC & Threat Intelligence Intern · Clinique Hannibal, Tunis — Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Deployed a full SOC: SIEM (ELK) and EDR (Wazuh) monitoring 50+ endpoints, with TheHive, Cortex and MISP for response and enrichment.
- Brought mean time to detect under 5 minutes; aligned controls with GDPR, HIPAA and ISO 27001.

Cybersecurity Intern · BNA Assurances, Tunis — Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Built an autonomous LLM (GPT-4) pentesting agent that plans engagements and orchestrates Nmap, Metasploit and OWASP ZAP, cutting analysis time by 60%.

SOC R&D Intern · Orange Tunisie, Tunis — Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Built an NLP phishing-detection model on 8,000+ emails (85% precision) and an automated pipeline that reduced analysis time by 40%.

EDUCATION

Engineering Degree, Networks & Information Systems Security · ESPRIT, Tunis — 2021 – 2026

Graduated with highest honours · final-year thesis (PFE) graded 17.38/20

RESEARCH & WRITING

DarkWatch: A Threat Intelligence Architecture for Dark Web Monitoring and Its Implications for Geopolitical Power Asymmetries · working paper, 2026

Digital Fortresses and Invisible Chains: A Political Anatomy of Cybersecurity · essay, Medium, Dec 2025

We All Look the Same Now: Notes on the Algorithmic Production of Sameness · essay, Medium, Dec 2025

PROJECTS

YT Trace · 2026 — local-only TypeScript browser extension that records and visualises one's own YouTube watch traces; no server, no tracking.

LexCyber AI — NLP/RAG over EU regulation (GDPR, NIS2, DORA) with CamemBERT and SentenceTransformers.

DevSecOps CI/CD pipeline — end-to-end pipeline with Jenkins and Docker, SAST (SonarQube, Semgrep), DAST (OWASP ZAP), container scanning (Trivy) and Prometheus/ Grafana monitoring.

IAM directory — Windows Server / Active Directory for 50+ users with RBAC, identity security policies and Kerberos SSO.

SKILLS

Detection & response Wazuh, ELK, Splunk, Suricata, Sigma, TheHive, Cortex, MISP

Offensive Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nuclei

Data & NLP Python, scikit-learn, pandas, TensorFlow, Transformers, RAG

Engineering FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, C/C++, Java

DevSecOps & cloud Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, SonarQube, Semgrep, Trivy, Azure

ENGAGEMENT & CURATION

Climate Project Manager at COP27, COP28 and SB60; coordinator, Fridays For Future MAPA

Lead curator, "Climax: Captures of a Rising Climate", Bonn Climate Camp (2025) and "Nature in Peril", Tunis (2023)

Zine workshop "Where We Come From", Bonn

LANGUAGES

Arabic (native) · French (C1) · English (C1, IELTS) · German (A2)